The Chest with Two Hinges

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 2

The chest lid rose and bumped the seat. Nib lowered it before it could scratch the wood. Its reversible hinge had been fitted on the walkway side. The four requested books remained dry in their compartments while Lark checked the fitting sketch.

“An enthusiastic lid,” Nib muttered. “A lid that needs room,” Lark replied calmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

sea

“Ch writes the single sound at the beginning of chip and chest,” Lark modeled clearly. “It differs from the flowing sh in ship. Read chip and chest, keeping each letter team together. Bench has that same ch sound at its end.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try chip, chest, bench. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read chest on the fitting sketch,” Lark invited gently. “Which hinge side leaves space for both lid and seat?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **A chest is shut. A bench is by it.**

“What is beside the chest?” Lark asked gently. “Does the passage say the chest is open?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib laid the lid flat on a supported work board. Lark held it while he moved the hinge pins to the correct side. Once refitted, the lid opened into clear space. The seat stayed secure, the walkway stayed usable, and the books stayed dry. At Commons, the first landing ramp waited above its proper support slot.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write chest beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark drew the corrected hinges in your journal. A lid could be enthusiastic without hitting anything now. The next job was making the ramp as useful to the cart as the chest was to the books.